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European EV Charging Infrastructure: Market Outlook 2026–2030

Executive summary

Public charge points in the region grew by 34% in 2025 to 1.12 million. We expect the installed base to reach 3.4 million by 2030, a compound annual growth rate of 25%, with fast chargers (over 50 kW) rising from 14% to 27% of points. Utilisation remains the industry's central problem: the median public charger was used for 9% of the day, below the 15% that most operators need to break even.

Market size

Segment	2025 points	2030 forecast	CAGR
Slow and destination (< 22 kW)	0.96 m	2.48 m	21%
Fast (50–150 kW)	0.12 m	0.61 m	38%
Ultra-fast (> 150 kW)	0.04 m	0.31 m	51%

Competitive landscape

The ten largest operators run 41% of points. Energy utilities are consolidating smaller networks, while fuel retailers focus on motorway hubs. Roaming agreements now cover 87% of fast chargers.

Key risks

- Grid connection delays of 12–30 months in dense cities.
- Price competition from home charging tariffs.
- Regulatory uncertainty about payment and pricing transparency.

Methodology

Forecasts combine vehicle registration scenarios with operator interviews and a survey of 1,200 drivers.